

Yash Kumar Lal

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Employment

Postdoctoral Scholar	Ohio State University	Jan 2026 – Present
Advisors: Huan Sun and Yu Su		
Research Intern	Google Research	Sep 2023 – Nov 2023
- Project Title: Automated Adversarial Discovery for Safety Classifiers - Mentors: Ananth Balashankar, Ahmad Beirami, Preethi Lahoti		
Research Intern	Allen Institute for AI	May 2023 – Aug 2023
- Project Title: Customizing Open-Domain Procedures - Mentor: Niket Tandon		
Research Intern	Salesforce Inc.	May 2022 – Aug 2022
- Project Title: Leveraging Knowledge Graphs for Pre-Training Question Decomposers - Mentors: Semih Yavuz, Ye Liu, Yingbo Zhou		

Education

Stony Brook, NY	Stony Brook University	August 2020 – December 2025
PhD in Computer Science. Advisor: Niranjana Balasubramanian.		
Baltimore, MD	Johns Hopkins University	August 2018 – May 2020
M.S.E. in Computer Science. Thesis: Low resource problems in NLP. Advisor: Philipp Koehn.		
Manipal, India	Manipal Institute of Technology	Aug 2014 – June 2018
B.Tech. in Computer Science Engineering.		

Technical Experience

Selected Publications

- MuSciClaims: Multimodal Scientific Claim Verification.** AACL 2025.
- Benchmarking LLM Understanding of Causal and Temporal Dependencies in Plans.** EMNLP 2024.
- Edit-Based Agents for Open-Domain Procedure Customization.** Findings of ACL, 2024.
- Automated Adversarial Discovery for Safety Classifiers.** TrustNLP@NAACL 2024.
- Socialite-Llama: An Instruction-Tuned Model for Social Scientific Tasks.** EACL 2024.
- Systematic Evaluation of GPT-3 for Zero-Shot Personality Estimation.** WASSA@ACL 2023.
- Evaluating Paraphrastic Robustness in Textual Entailment Models.** ACL 2023.
- Using Commonsense Knowledge to Answer Why-Questions.** EMNLP 2022.
- TellMeWhy: A Dataset for Answering Why-Questions in Narratives.** Findings of ACL-IJCNLP, 2021.
- IrEne: Interpretable Energy Prediction for Transformers.** ACL-IJCNLP, 2021.
- Temporal Reasoning in Natural Language Inference.** Findings of EMNLP, 2020.
- De-Mixing Sentiment from Code-Mixed Text.** ACL Student Research Workshop, 2019.
- Identifying Clickbait: A Multi-Strategy Approach Using Neural Networks.** SIGIR, 2018.

Service and Awards

- Runner-Up, Best Long Paper,** Fourth Workshop on Trustworthy NLP, NAACL 2024
- Chair:** NAACL 2022 Reproducibility Track, EMNLP 2025 Publicity Chair
- Workshop Organizer:** Narrative Understanding, '24-25; Commonsense Representation and Reasoning, '22
- Reviewer:** ECIR '19, '21; WMT '19; TALLIP '20; EMNLP '21-'23; ACL Rolling Review Nov '21 - present
- Program Committee:** ACL SRW '20-'21; AACL SRW '20; NAACL '21; NAACL SRW '21, ACL '23
- Winner, Acceleprise Award** at AngelHack Global Demo Day '17, San Francisco; AngelHack Hyderabad '17